

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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EXPERIENCE

StaffRoom AI

Emeryville, CA

Founder & AI Solutions Consultant

October 2023 - Present

- Scope the technical requirements with the customer, then build a working proof before a larger build. Engagements are milestone-gated and have reached \$18K.
- Build the integrations and data pipelines that connect a customer's existing systems to the workflow. One ingestion rebuild raised throughput 99.8% in four months and cut cost 86%.
- Turn a marketing or operations goal into a deployed AI workflow: n8n, Python, REST, and webhooks, with Claude Code as the daily build tool.
- Designed a content-production system for an agency and enabled the people running it. Production volume increased 10x after the workflow went live.
- Ship custom behavior the customer can see in their own data, then fold the repeated piece back into the next engagement instead of rebuilding it.
- Stay through launch: resolve breakage, keep a backlog, and report the measured result. The operator stays the decision-maker.
- Write the spec from discovery notes so engineering is not guessing. Prompts and review gates are part of the deliverable, not a later cleanup.

IBM

Austin, TX

Data Engineer / Cognitive Software Engineer, Customer Support

August 2018 - December 2020

- Partnered with the people who used the tool: Design Thinking sessions, then release notes, so a change landed in the workflow they already had.
- Built data pipelines and a Slack NLP assistant (DRE Bot) plus IBMLogAnalyze, which removed 1-3 hours of per-case prep. Reported results in Tableau and Cognos.

Valhalla Healthcare

Remote

Machine Learning Engineer (Intern)

May 2021 - August 2021

- Shipped a Python model from messy source documents to a usable data model (F1 80.03) for a single customer, on a short engagement.

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder

Boulder, CO

B.S. Information Science; Major GPA 3.7 | Certificate of Cognitive Science; Dean's List

August 2018 - May 2023

IBM

Online

Systems & Solutions Architecture Professional Certificate (in progress)

expected July 2026

- BPMN, process improvement, systems design, and cloud-native delivery.

SKILLS

Forward deployed: discovery, proofs of concept, integrations, data pipelines, production handover, field notes back to the product. **Stack:** Python, TypeScript, SQL, REST, webhooks, n8n, Claude Code, MCP, Claude / OpenAI / Gemini APIs.